

Award → Alumni (the umbrella arc)

WHAT IT IS

The whole story the platform tells, in ten dots:

THE CLICKS

01 Frame the run

WHERE Sidebar → **Dashboard**.

DO Say what you're about to do out loud: create an award, use it to publish an opportunity, take an application, register the student, follow them to graduation.

SEE The dashboard KPI row. Don't linger.

SAY *“For the next twenty minutes I'm going to build a student from scratch — from the funder's grant to their graduation. Everything I do is real; nothing is pre-loaded.”*

THE LINE

“We're not going to walk pages. We're going to build a student, live, from a funder's grant to their graduation.”

Research awards — create one live

WHAT IT IS

A funder gives the institution money for research. In this demo we create a real award for a fictional grant — funder, value, term, headcount — and save it. That saved record becomes the top of everything downstream: the opportunities we post in the next chapter, the funding arrangements each student will have, the audit trail the compliance officer follows a year later. Awards move through their own lifecycle: **draft** → **active** → **closed**.

THE CLICKS

01 Open the awards list

WHERE Sidebar → **Research** (flask icon) → **Awards** tab.

DO Land on the awards list. Note the counts at the top: total awards, active, closed.

SEE Existing awards as rows with funder, value, term, headcount, status pill.

SAY *“Every research grant the institution has won is here. I’m going to add a new one live.”*

02 Start a new award

WHERE Top-right of the list → **+ New award** button.

DO Click. A form drawer slides in.

SEE Blank form: funder, reference, title, value, currency, valid_from, valid_to, studentships_funded, research_area, notes.

SAY *“Everything about the grant is one form. No email attachments to chase.”*

03 Fill the award

WHERE In the form.

DO Type these values:

Funder — UKRI EPSRC

Reference — EP/Z000000/1

Title — CDT in Applied AI · Cohort 2027

Value — 1,860,000 **Currency** — GBP

Valid from — 2026-10-01 **Valid to** — 2030-09-30

Studentships funded — 10

Research area — pick Machine Learning

Notes — Four-year full-time studentships. Includes stipend, fees, RTSG.

SEE Value auto-formats with commas. Field validation ticks green as each required field is filled.

SAY *“Ten studentships, four years each, £1.86m in total. Real numbers a funder would recognise.”*

04 Save and see it become real

WHERE Bottom-right → **Save award** button.

DO Click. Wait a beat.

SEE Drawer closes. New row appears at the top of the awards list with status pill "Active" and a green flash on the row.

SAY *“The award is live. Any admin can now attach opportunities to it. The audit log has already recorded who created it and when — I can prove that at any point.”*

THE LINE

“Every funded student's story starts here — one grant, one form, one row, dated and audited.”

Opportunities — publish one from the award

WHAT IT IS

The award we just created pays for ten studentships. Each becomes an **opportunity** — a real posting with a title, a supervisor, a research area, an eligibility rule, an open/close window, and a link back to the award that funds it. In this chapter we create one, fill in a supervisor, publish it, and land on the page an applicant would see. Opportunities are the seam between money and people.

THE CLICKS

01 Open the opportunities list

WHERE Sidebar → **Recruitment** (megaphone icon) → **Opportunities** tab (or top-of-page toolbar).

DO Land on the list.

SEE Existing opportunities as rows: title, supervisor, close date, application count, status pill.

SAY *“Every studentship we’re recruiting for is here. I’m going to add a new one against the award I just created.”*

02 Start a new opportunity

WHERE Top-right → **+ New opportunity** button.

DO Click. Form drawer opens.

SEE Fields: funded_by (award link), title, description, supervisor, research_area, eligibility, open_date, close_date, headcount, remote/on-site.

SAY *“Every opportunity has to link back to the award that funds it — no unfunded postings by accident.”*

03 Link it to our award

WHERE First field: **Funded by**.

DO Type or pick EP/Z000000/1 · CDT in Applied AI · Cohort 2027. Autocomplete filters as you type.

SEE A chip appears with the award reference. Studentship remaining count updates: **9 remaining** (was 10).

SAY *“Ten studentships on the grant, one now allocated. Nine left. The system won’t let me over-commit.”*

04 Fill the posting

WHERE Rest of the form.

DO Type:

Title — PhD in Explainable Reinforcement Learning

Supervisor — pick Dr. Elena Ford (existing supervisor record)

Research area — Machine Learning (inherited from award, editable)

Eligibility — UK / EU / International. First-class or 2:1 honours in CS, Maths, or Physics. English test if not native.

Open date — today

Close date — six weeks out

Headcount — 1

Mode — On-site

SEE Every required field ticks green.

SAY *“The supervisor is a real person — the platform checked they're active and have headroom against their cap.”*

05 Save as draft, then publish

WHERE Bottom of the drawer.

DO Click **Save as draft** first. Row appears with grey "Draft" pill. Then reopen and click **Publish**.

SEE Status pill flips to green "Open". A public URL appears in the detail panel.

SAY *“Draft while I'm iterating — nothing goes public. Publish and it's live for applicants.”*

THE LINE

“The award funded it, the platform posted it. The moment we publish, the outside world enters the arc.”

Recruitment — an application arrives and gets triaged

WHAT IT IS

The opportunity is live. Now an applicant applies to it. In this chapter we submit an application against our published posting, then switch personas (admin) and triage it through the pipeline: **submitted** → **shortlisted** → **in review** → **offered**. Every state change is a dated fact with an actor. The application record we create here is the same row that will become a student's record two chapters from now.

THE CLICKS

01 Submit an application (applicant view)

WHERE Public opportunity page (from previous chapter) → **Apply** button.

DO Fill the applicant form: name Priya Nair, email priya.nair@example.com, nationality Indian, previous degree, motivation statement, references.

SEE Progress bar showing 5/5 sections complete. Submit button enables.

SAY *“An applicant applies once. Everything they type here is the same record we'll manage all the way through their PhD.”*

02 Submit and get the reference

WHERE Bottom of the form → **Submit application**.

DO Click. Confirmation page appears with a reference number and a "check status" link.

SEE Reference like APP-2026-004871.

SAY *“The reference is the applicant's tracking id. The record is already on our side, in the pipeline.”*

03 Switch to admin. See the application land

WHERE Log in as admin → Sidebar → **Recruitment** → main pipeline.

DO Filter by opportunity: PhD in Explainable Reinforcement Learning. Find Priya Nair's row.

SEE New row with "submitted" status pill, timestamp, opportunity link, applicant name.

SAY *“The pipeline is one screen for every application across the department. New submissions come in with a submitted pill.”*

04 Open the application, decide to shortlist

WHERE Click Priya's row.

DO Read the application. In the top-right action bar → **Shortlist**. Add a reason: "Strong motivation statement, previous ML work matches area".

SEE Status pill flips to amber "Shortlisted". A new row appears in the state timeline on the right.

SAY *“Every state change is a dated fact with a reason. Auditors love this.”*

05 Move to "in review", assign the panel

WHERE Same action bar → **Send to review**.

DO Assign a reviewer (Dr. Elena Ford as supervisor is default) and any panel members. Confirm.

SEE Status pill "In review". A task appears in Elena's task inbox: "Review application from Priya Nair".

SAY *"The task fires automatically. Elena will see it when she opens the platform tomorrow morning."*

THE LINE

"Every application is a dated row on one pipeline. Every state change carries an actor and a reason."

Admissions — issue a conditional offer, clear the conditions, register

WHAT IT IS

The application is at "offered". Now we issue a conditional offer with typed conditions (English test, transcripts, references), watch them clear one by one, and — when the last one ticks — press **Register** and turn the applicant into a real student. Same record the whole time. Downstream, a funding arrangement will spawn against the award because the opportunity was funded.

THE CLICKS

01 Open the admissions queue

WHERE Sidebar → **Admissions** (file-check icon).

DO Filter by "Offered". Find Priya Nair's row.

SEE Row with amber pill and a "Draft conditional offer" button.

SAY ""Applications that reach 'offered' land here. Admissions turns them into offers.""

02 Draft the conditional offer

WHERE Priya's row → **Draft conditional offer**.

DO On the form, tick the conditions to attach: English language (IELTS 7.0), Certified transcripts, Two academic references. Set offer expiry: 4 weeks.

SEE Three condition rows appear, each with a status pill: "Open".

SAY ""Conditions are typed, not free-text. English test, transcripts, references — three items, three clearing gates.""

03 Send the offer

WHERE Bottom of the form → **Send offer to applicant**.

DO Click. Confirm.

SEE Status flips to "Offer sent". An email row appears in the outbox — the offer letter, ready to deliver.

SAY ""The offer is out. Everything from here — applicant accepting, conditions clearing — updates the same record.""

04 Applicant accepts (simulate)

WHERE On the offer detail → **Simulate: applicant accepts**.

DO Click. (In production this arrives via the applicant's portal or an inbound webhook.)

SEE Offer status flips to "Accepted". Three conditions still amber.

SAY ""Acceptance is one dated fact. The registration is still gated on the conditions.""

05 Clear the conditions one by one

WHERE Each condition row → **Upload evidence** button.

DO Upload the applicant's IELTS certificate (any PDF), tick "Verified". Repeat for transcripts and references.

SEE Each condition pill flips to green "Cleared". The **Register** button, previously greyed, turns Redwood red on the last tick.

SAY *“Conditions clear as evidence lands. The Register button unlocks itself — no admin discretion.”*

06 Press Register — the seam

WHERE Top-right → **Register**.

DO Click. Confirm.

SEE Modal shows registration event: student ref auto-generated (e.g. PGR-2026-A9F102), start date today, expected end four years out. Confirm.

SAY *“One click. The applicant becomes a student. Same row all along.”*

THE LINE

“The seam between applicant and student is one click. Everywhere else, it's a fresh spreadsheet.”

Supervisor allocation — assign primary, add co, later change

WHAT IT IS

Priya is registered. The supervisor from her opportunity (Elena Ford) auto-attaches as primary at 100%. Now we add a methods co-supervisor (Prof. Roland Vega, 40%) and, later in the demo, we simulate a change-of-supervisor request. Every action is a dated fact with a reason; weightings count against the supervisor's cap on the workforce lens.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Priya's supervision panel

WHERE Sidebar → **Students** → Priya Nair → scroll to **Supervisors** panel.

DO Show the current state: Elena as primary at 100%.

SEE One row with role "Primary", weighting "100%", valid_from today.

SAY *“Elena auto-attached because the opportunity was under her name. That's the default — we can add and adjust.”*

02 Add a co-supervisor

WHERE Top-right of the panel → **+ Add supervisor**.

DO In the form: pick Prof. Roland Vega, role Co-supervisor, weighting 40%, reason Methods expertise for RL work. Save.

SEE Elena's weighting auto-adjusts from 100% to 60%. New row appears for Roland at 40%. Total = 100%.

SAY *“Weightings have to sum to 100. The platform rebalances Elena's automatically.”*

03 Verify Roland's caseload updated

WHERE Sidebar → **Workforce** → find Roland's row.

DO Point at his current load and headroom.

SEE Load went up by 0.4 of a student. Headroom column reflects it.

SAY *“40% on Priya counts as 0.4 against Roland's cap. Real, weighted, department-wide.”*

04 Simulate a change request (later in the demo)

WHERE Back on Priya's record → **Supervisors** panel → Roland's row → **Request change**.

DO Fill form: proposed new supervisor Dr. Anna Costa, reason Roland moving institutions, end_date old = start_date new.

SEE Change request row appears with amber "Pending review" pill.

SAY *“Every change carries a reason. The old relationship's end-date and the new one's start-date move together.”*

THE LINE

“Every supervision decision is a dated fact with a reason attached — never an “as-of-today” guess.”

Progression — create a milestone, submit, form the panel, decide

WHAT IT IS

Priya's programme has typed milestones — confirmation review (month 9), transfer viva (month 18), annual review (yearly). In this chapter we create her upcoming confirmation review, watch her submit into it, form the review panel, record decisions from each panellist, and land on the final panel outcome. Every step is preserved on one record; if the outcome is appealed later, the appeal opens without overwriting anything.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Priya's milestones panel

WHERE Sidebar → **Students** → Priya Nair → **Milestones** panel.

DO See the auto-created milestones for her programme.

SEE Confirmation Review (due month 9), Transfer Viva (month 18), Annual Review 1 (month 12).

SAY *“Programme-level definitions auto-create the milestones when the student registers. No admin has to know which ones apply.”*

02 Open the Confirmation Review

WHERE Click the "Confirmation Review" row.

DO Land on the milestone detail page.

SEE Three empty panels: **Panel formation**, **Student submission**, **Supervisor assessment**. Status: "Not started".

SAY *“The milestone is a mini-workflow with three panels. All three feed one decision.”*

03 Form the panel

WHERE **Panel formation** panel → **+ Add member**.

DO Add chair Prof. Sarah Wu, member Dr. Rajesh Kumar. Save.

SEE Panel row now shows chair + one member. Status of the milestone flips to "Due".

SAY *“Chair plus at least one member. The platform enforces the composition rule.”*

04 Simulate the student submission

WHERE **Student submission** panel → **Upload submission** (as student persona, or admin proxy).

DO Upload any PDF as Priya's Chapter 1 draft. Fill the summary field.

SEE Panel populates with the file, timestamp, "Submitted" pill.

SAY *“Student's own submission — the workflow now waits on the supervisor's assessment.”*

05 Supervisor assessment

WHERE Supervisor assessment panel → **Start assessment** (as Elena).

DO Fill: overall rating "Meets expectations", comment "Good progress on the RL survey chapter, methodology needs strengthening", recommend "Pass with minor conditions".

SEE Assessment saved with timestamp. Milestone status flips to "Under review".

SAY *“Supervisor’s view is on the record before the panel decides — no political pressure to align.”*

06 Record the panel decision

WHERE Bottom of the milestone page → **Panel decision** button.

DO Fill: outcome Progress with conditions, conditions Redraft chapter 2 within 12 weeks, rationale paragraph. Save.

SEE Decision recorded. Milestone status flips to "Decided". Two things fire: a task to Priya ("chapter 2 redraft due"), a follow-up milestone check scheduled 12 weeks out.

SAY *“The decision is preserved verbatim. The next-step tasks fire automatically.”*

THE LINE

“The state machine does the checking. The paperwork does itself.”

Funding — see the arrangement that spawned, add a stipend payment, reconcile

WHAT IT IS

When we registered Priya in chapter 04, the platform auto-created a **funding arrangement** against the award we made in chapter 01. That arrangement carries the stipend schedule; every month, a payment row lands. In this chapter we open the arrangement, look at the schedule, mark a payment as landed, then find and clear a reconciliation row on the funding-integrity page.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Priya's funding

WHERE Priya's student page → **Funding** panel (or Sidebar → **Funding** → filter by her name).

DO Show the arrangement that auto-created on registration.

SEE One arrangement row: type Research council, source UKRI EPSRC — EP/Z000000/1, valid_from today, valid_to +4 years, status active.

SAY *“The arrangement spawned automatically. Award → opportunity → registration → arrangement. Zero admin action.”*

02 Show the funding lineage tree

WHERE Same page → **Funding lineage** panel.

DO Point at the tree: **UKRI EPSRC** (top) → **EP/Z000000/1** (award) → **arrangement** → **Priya Nair** (bottom).

SEE Four-tier tree, edges labelled “funds”.

SAY *“Four levels: funder, award, arrangement, student. Trace this £74,400 for me — the graph is the answer.”*

03 Open the stipend schedule

WHERE Click the arrangement → **Stipend schedule** section.

DO Show the auto-generated monthly rows for the four-year term.

SEE 48 rows, one per month, each with due_date and amount (£1,552).

SAY *“Payments schedule themselves. No one types 48 rows.”*

04 Mark a payment as landed

WHERE Any past-due payment row → **Mark paid**.

DO Click. Enter reference: UKRI-PAY-2027-02-4471. Confirm.

SEE Row flips to green “Paid”. Total-paid count on the arrangement goes up by £1,552.

SAY *“Real payment reference from the funder. Every payment traceable to a real transfer.”*

05 Find a reconciliation gap

WHERE Sidebar → **Funding integrity** (shield-alert icon).

DO Filter to Priya's arrangement. Point at any amber row.

SEE Row showing paid-so-far vs expected-so-far with the delta.

SAY *“If UKRI paid less than the arrangement says, it shows here. Every mismatch surfaces.”*

THE LINE

“Every pound has a paper trail — from the funder, through the award, through the arrangement, to the payment.”

Suspension & extension — request one, approve it, watch everything downstream move

WHAT IT IS

Priya needs three months off. In this chapter we request a suspension against her record, approve it, and watch three things move automatically: her expected end date shifts by exactly three months, her stipend schedule pauses for the same window, and her workflow tasks pause with her. If she has an employment record (a TA post) it's untouched — the two lifecycles are independent.

THE CLICKS

01 Note the "before" state

WHERE Priya's student page → **Record** section.

DO Point at **Expected end** (e.g. 2030-10-15) and the **status** pill (green "Registered").

SEE One date, one green pill.

SAY *""Watch these two things. In two clicks they'll both move — and they'll move together.""*

02 Open the suspension request form

WHERE Same page → **Lifecycle** panel → **Request suspension** button.

DO Click. Form opens.

SEE Fields: reason, duration_months, start_date, notes.

SAY *""A suspension isn't a status change — it's a dated fact with a reason and a duration.""*

03 Fill the request

WHERE In the form.

DO Fill: reason Medical leave, duration 3, start_date today, notes Approved by wellbeing team, doc on file.

SEE Preview shows the projected shifted end date.

SAY *""Preview shows the shift before we commit. No surprises.""*

04 Save. Approve in the queue

WHERE **Submit request**. Then Sidebar → **Tasks** or **Workflow queue** → find the approval task.

DO Open it, click **Approve**.

SEE Status pill on Priya's record flips from green "Registered" to amber "Suspended". Task closes. New audit rows.

SAY *""Suspension approved. Every downstream field now knows about it.""*

05 Confirm the "after" state

WHERE Back on Priya's page.

DO Point at **Expected end** and the **status** pill.

SEE Expected end shifted forward by three months (e.g. 2031-01-15). Original date visible in the audit history.

SAY *“Expected end shifted by exactly three months. Automatically. No admin retyped anything.”*

06 Show the paused stipend

WHERE Priya's funding arrangement → stipend schedule.

DO Point at rows in the suspension window (marked "Paused") and the schedule tail extending three months later.

SEE Three amber "Paused" rows in the middle; the schedule continues three months longer at the end.

SAY *“Stipend pauses. It doesn't stop — it picks up where we left off, three months later.”*

THE LINE

“Pausing a PhD is one action, and everything downstream — deadlines, tasks, funding, workflows — moves in step.”

Thesis — intent to submit, nominate examiners, catch the Col, schedule the viva

WHAT IT IS

Priya has passed all her milestones. She signals intent to submit. In this chapter we record that intent, nominate two examiners (internal + external), watch the conflict-of-interest check refuse one and accept the other, schedule the viva, record the outcome, track corrections, and land at "award ready". The corrections have their own sub-workflow; the award button only unlocks when they close.

THE CLICKS

01 Record the intent to submit

WHERE Priya's student page → **Thesis** panel → + **Record intent to submit**.

DO Fill: intended submission date (three months out), working title Explainable Reinforcement Learning for Clinical Decision Support.

SEE A thesis row appears with status "Intent recorded". A task appears for the graduate school: "Start examiner nomination for Priya Nair".

SAY ""Student signals intent, and the examiner nomination workflow starts. No one waits for the deadline.""

02 Nominate an internal examiner (that conflicts)

WHERE Same panel → **Examiners** section → + **Nominate internal**.

DO Type Prof. Roland Vega (Priya's former co-supervisor).

SEE Red banner: "Cannot nominate — served as co-supervisor on this thesis."

SAY ""The system knows. Roland was on the record as co-supervisor — he can't examine his own student.""

03 Try a plausible but conflicted external

WHERE Same field, or + **Nominate external**.

DO Type Prof. Jian Kwan (fictional external, has co-authored with Roland).

SEE Amber warning: "Co-authored with Prof. Vega in 2024 — reviewer discretion required." Approve or reject buttons appear.

SAY ""Not disqualifying, but flagged. Prof. Vega's on the record, and Kwan's on a paper with him — worth knowing before the viva.""

04 Nominate a clean external

WHERE Same field.

DO Type Prof. Aisha Adekunle (no prior links). Click **Save nomination**.

SEE Green tick badge. Examiner-invitation workflow task appears in the outbox.

SAY ""Green. Nomination saved. Invitation goes out automatically — no email chain to chase.""

05 Schedule the viva

WHERE Thesis panel → **Viva** section → **Schedule viva**.

DO Fill: date, chair, mode (in-person / hybrid). Save.

SEE Viva row appears with "Scheduled" pill. Calendar invites emit through the outbox.

SAY *“Viva scheduled. Every party gets a calendar invite via the integration outbox — retried if a partner is slow.”*

06 Record the viva outcome

WHERE After the viva (simulate) → **Viva** section → **Record outcome**.

DO Fill: outcome Pass with minor corrections, deadline for corrections (3 months out), notes.

SEE Viva status flips to "Outcome recorded". Corrections sub-workflow opens with state "Not started".

SAY *“Outcome preserved. The corrections sub-workflow opens — the award button stays greyed until they close.”*

THE LINE

“The most compliance-heavy stretch of the arc has the least paperwork — because the state machine does the checking.”

Completion & alumni — record the award, set classification, graduate

WHAT IT IS

The corrections closed. The **Record award** button unlocked. In this chapter we record Priya's degree award (the second "award" — the graduation one, not the funder's), set the classification, generate the certificate reference, and watch her record move from "Progressing" to "Graduated". The same row that started this demo as a research grant now closes as an alumnus.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Completion for Priya

WHERE Sidebar → **Completion** (award icon) → filter by Priya Nair.

DO See her pending completion row.

SEE Row with an amber "Ready for award" pill; **Record award** button available.

SAY *"Priya's ready. Corrections closed, viva outcome recorded. The completion queue picks her up automatically."*

02 Record the award

WHERE Click Priya's row → **Record award**.

DO Fill form: award date today, degree PhD, thesis title (auto-filled), certificate reference UBAI-PHD-2031-0142.

SEE Fields validate; certificate reference is unique-checked.

SAY *"The degree award is one form. Once recorded, the workflow moves to classification."*

03 Set the classification

WHERE Same page → **Classification** section.

DO Fill: outcome Pass, rationale paragraph, examiner attribution. Save.

SEE Classification card populates. Status pill flips to green "Graduated".

SAY *"Classification with rationale — auditable, exportable, immutable."*

04 See Priya move to Alumni

WHERE Priya's person page → **Timeline**.

DO Point at the new **Alumni** segment starting today.

SEE Timeline: Applicant → Student → Alumni. Same person, same record, four years of history intact.

SAY *"The row that started as an applicant closes as an alumna. Same record all the way through."*

THE LINE

"The row that started as an applicant closes as an alumnus — same record, same audit trail, all the way through."

Workflow engine — define a new cycle live

WHAT IT IS

Every cycle you've watched — admissions, milestones, suspension, thesis, corrections, completion — is a definition on the same generic engine. Not code. Data. In this chapter we create a new workflow definition end-to-end (e.g. "Ethics approval") — states, transitions, actions on transition — save it, activate it, then start an instance and drive it through. Adding a new cycle to the platform doesn't need a deploy.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Workflows

WHERE Sidebar → **Workflows** (under ADMINISTRATION).

DO Show the list. Point at existing definitions (Onboarding, Milestone, Thesis, Correction).

SEE Rows: key, name, active toggle, version, instances count.

SAY *“Every cycle we've watched is one row here. The engine doesn't know what a milestone is — it moves state.”*

02 Create a new definition

WHERE Top-right → + **New workflow**.

DO Fill: key `ethics_approval`, name `Ethics approval`, `initial_state` `submitted`, version 1.

SEE Form drawer with sections for states, transitions, and actions.

SAY *“I'm going to add a whole new cycle in three minutes. No deploy.”*

03 Define the states

WHERE **States** section.

DO Add rows: `submitted`, `under_review`, `approved`, `rejected`, `needs_amendment`.

SEE Five state pills.

SAY *“Five states. Nothing fancy. The vocabulary is the ethics committee's own.”*

04 Define the transitions

WHERE Transitions section → + Add transition.

DO Add rows:

from submitted → on assign → to under_review → action createTask (assignee_role: Ethics Reviewer)

from under_review → on approve → to approved → action notify (person: applicant)

from under_review → on reject → to rejected → action notify

from under_review → on request_amendment → to needs_amendment → action createTask (assignee: applicant)

from needs_amendment → on resubmit → to submitted

SEE Transitions listed with from/on/to/action cells.

SAY *“Every transition can fire actions. Tasks land in inboxes, notifications reach the right people. All out of the box.”*

05 Save and activate

WHERE Bottom → **Save**, then toggle **Active**.

DO Click both.

SEE Definition appears in the list with a green "Active" pill and version 1.

SAY *“Live. Any part of the system can now start an ethics_approval instance.”*

THE LINE

“Adding a new cycle isn't a code change — it's a definition, data-driven, versioned.”

Task inbox — pick up a task fired by a workflow

WHAT IT IS

Every state change we've done so far has fired tasks: "review application", "clear conditions", "form the panel", "record assessment", "invite examiners". They all land in the task inbox routed by role — anyone with that role can pick them up, so cover doesn't need a handover. In this chapter we filter down to the tasks we (and our workflow instance) generated, pick one up, complete it, and watch the workflow advance behind it.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Tasks

WHERE Sidebar → **Tasks** (checkbox icon, under WORKSPACE).

DO Land on the inbox filtered by "assigned to my roles".

SEE Rows: title, entity link, due date, state pill (Open / In progress / Done).

SAY *“Every task the workflow engine emitted for me is here. Nothing arrives by memory.”*

02 Filter to a specific entity

WHERE Filter bar at the top.

DO Filter by entity = Priya Nair.

SEE Tasks we generated along the demo: examiner nominations, corrections review, etc.

SAY *“Every task from every workflow instance, filterable by the entity it's about.”*

03 Pick one up

WHERE Any open task row → **Take**.

DO Click. State pill flips to "In progress" and assignee flips to me by name.

SEE Task moves out of the shared queue into my personal one.

SAY *“Tasks route to a role first, a person second. Anyone in the role can pick one up — cover doesn't require a handover.”*

04 Complete it

WHERE Same task → **Mark done**.

DO Add a completion note if the task asks for one. Confirm.

SEE State pill flips to green "Done". The workflow instance behind it advances to its next state. If that new state fires more actions, new tasks appear.

SAY *“Completing a task is a state transition. The workflow moves. New tasks appear if the next transition needs one — chained work without email chains.”*

THE LINE

“If it isn't in the task inbox, no one is on the hook for it — and if the workflow emits it, it's there.”

Integration & webhooks — send an event out, receive one in, replay a failed one

WHAT IT IS

The platform talks to the outside world in both directions. Every business event (registration, funding change, viva outcome, etc.) queues into the **outbox**, gets delivered to the right partner adapter, retried with backoff on failure. Every inbound webhook (funder confirms payment, HR confirms employment, etc.) lands on our endpoint, normalises into a business event, and a workflow reacts. In this chapter we watch an outbound event queue and deliver, receive an inbound webhook that updates Priya's arrangement, then simulate a failed delivery and replay it.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Integration

WHERE Sidebar → **Integration** (cable icon, ADMINISTRATION).

DO Show adapters and delivery report tiles at the top.

SEE Counts: ok / retrying / failed in the last 24 hours.

SAY *“Every partner is an adapter. Every message we send is in the outbox. Every message we receive is a row in the inbound log.”*

02 Watch an outbound event queue

WHERE On Priya's record (from earlier) → **Send registration notice to UKRI** button (or trigger by adjusting something on her funding).

DO Click. Back on Integration → **Outbox** tab.

SEE New row: event student.registered, target UKRI adapter, attempt 1, delivered at (timestamp).

SAY *“There it is. Between our click and the partner receiving it, the outbox handles delivery — retries on our side, not on the caller's.”*

03 Simulate an inbound webhook

WHERE Same page → **Inbound** tab → **Simulate webhook** (dev-only button).

DO Pick source UKRI, event payment.confirmed, entity Priya's arrangement, amount 1552. Send.

SEE Row appears in inbound log. A business event fires — one of Priya's stipend rows flips from "Due" to "Paid".

SAY *“Webhook → normalise → business event → workflow reacts. All visible.”*

04 Force a failed delivery, then replay

WHERE **Outbox** tab → **Simulate failure** on a queued row (dev-only).

DO Confirm. Watch the row turn amber "retrying".

SEE Retry timeline: attempts with backoff (1 min, 2 min, 4 min).

SAY *“Nothing is fire-and-forget. If a partner is down for two hours, we retry with backoff and land the message when they come back.”*

THE LINE

“Every message we send and receive is a first-class record — not a console log.”

Statutory reporting — draft a HESA return, reconcile, sign off, file

WHAT IT IS

HESA (Higher Education Statistics Agency), OfS, research council returns — all built from the same Enterprise 360 read model that runs internal analytics. In this chapter we open the current-cycle HESA return draft (Priya's registration in this demo has already contributed a row), check the reconciliation banner, sign it off, and watch the filing task land in the integration outbox.

THE CLICKS

01 Show the shared source of truth

WHERE Sidebar → **Analytics** (globe icon).

DO Show the five-lens tabs across the top of the table: Student / Research / Funding / Workforce / Statutory.

SEE One row per person. Switching tabs re-projects the same rows through different fields.

SAY *“One row per person. Five lenses. Every internal report and every statutory return draws from this same view.”*

02 Open the HESA draft

WHERE Sidebar → **Statutory** → **HESA Student return** → **Current cycle**.

DO Show the draft return.

SEE One row per student in scope, statutory fields down the columns, reconciliation banner at the top.

SAY *“Draft return. Fields are the HESA schema; rows come straight off the 360 view.”*

03 Reconcile

WHERE Top of the return page.

DO Point at the reconciliation row: "Matches operational totals" in green.

SEE Green tick. Deltas column empty.

SAY *“The return numbers reconcile with operational screens by construction — because there's only one source.”*

04 Sign it off

WHERE Top-right → **Sign off** button.

DO Click. Modal asks for a sign-off note ("reviewed against operational totals, no outstanding queries"). Confirm.

SEE Status flips from "Draft" to "Signed off" with your name and timestamp.

SAY *“Sign-off is a workflow transition. Preserved forever with who and when.”*

THE LINE

“The dashboard and the HESA return are the same numbers, always. No sub-reports drifting from the source.”

Notifications — set preferences, watch one fire, silence a noisy kind

WHAT IT IS

Every workflow transition and every AI signal can emit a notification. Users pick their channel per kind — in-app, email, or off — and the daily digest rolls up everything low-priority so people aren't drowned. In this chapter we open Elena's notification preferences, silence a kind she doesn't want, fire a workflow transition that would have hit her, and confirm it did NOT reach her while OTHER kinds still did.

THE CLICKS

01 Show the bell

WHERE Top-right of any page → notification bell icon.

DO Click. Show the list of recent notifications.

SEE Rows: title, source (which workflow / which AI signal), timestamp, read pill.

SAY *“Every workflow transition we’ve done in this demo added a row here. Same source of truth.”*

02 Open preferences

WHERE User menu (bottom-left avatar) → **Notification preferences**. (Or Sidebar → Settings → Notifications tab.)

DO Show the per-kind matrix.

SEE Rows per notification kind (Milestone due, Panel decision, Funding change, Application received, etc.), columns for in-app / email / off.

SAY *“Users choose their own channel per kind. Directors get everything by email; supervisors keep it in-app.”*

03 Silence a kind

WHERE Find "Funding integrity reconciliation" row.

DO Set all three columns to "off". Save.

SEE Preference row shows "silenced". A confirmation toast.

SAY *“I’ve told the system I don’t care about reconciliation dings. That preference sticks.”*

04 Fire something that would have hit that kind

WHERE Sidebar → **Funding integrity** → find an amber row → click **Resolve**.

DO Confirm.

SEE Reconciliation resolved. Back on the bell → no new "reconciliation" row for me. But if another notification fired at the same time (e.g. a task completion) — it did show up.

SAY *“Silenced kinds don’t reach me. Other kinds still do. The preference is fine-grained, not all-or-nothing.”*

THE LINE

“The system tells the right person, on the right channel, at the right cadence — and only what they asked for.”

Audit — answer an auditor's question by URL, not by spreadsheet

WHAT IT IS

Every write, every state change, every login, every export — one immutable log row with actor, entity, action, timestamp, request id, before/after payload. Filter by any axis (who did what, or what was done to whom); export a slice; share a URL that preserves the filter. In this chapter we play out a real auditor's question — *"who registered student PGR-2026-A9F102, and did the funding attach correctly?"* — and answer it with two filters and a copied URL.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Audit

WHERE Sidebar → **Audit** (under ADMINISTRATION).

DO Land on the table with today's activity.

SEE Rows: time, actor, action, entity, before/after link.

SAY *"Every write in the system is here. Nothing bypasses this log."*

02 Filter by our new student

WHERE Filter bar → **Entity type = Student, Entity ID/ref = PGR-2026-A9F102** (Priya's ref from chapter 04).

DO Apply.

SEE Rows: registered by (admin), supervisors added, funding arrangement auto-created, milestones auto-created — all chronological, all from this demo.

SAY *"Every state change on Priya's record. Who moved her, when, with what request id."*

03 Zoom into one row

WHERE Any row → click.

DO Show the before/after payload preview.

SEE Two JSON blobs side by side — the field values before and after the change.

SAY *"Before and after. If someone asks 'what changed?', it's literally right there."*

04 Change axis to actor

WHERE Same filter bar.

DO Clear entity filter; set **Actor = admin@example.com, Date = today**.

SEE Every action that admin took today — award created, opportunity published, application shortlisted, offer issued, student registered.

SAY *"The other axis. Auditors ask 'who did what today?' — this is the answer."*

THE LINE

"The auditor doesn't send you a spreadsheet request — you filter this page and send them the URL."

Documents — upload a chapter draft, watch it scan, download and see the log

WHAT IT IS

Documents get uploaded, virus-scanned by a background worker, stored in object storage, and linked to the business entity that owns them (a person, a milestone, a thesis, an offer condition). Every download is logged with the actor and the timestamp. Visibility follows the entity's permissions — if you can't open the entity, you can't open the file. In this chapter we upload a real PDF against Priya's Chapter 2 revision, watch the scan complete, download the file, and confirm the download shows up in the audit log.

THE CLICKS

01 Find the right document panel

WHERE Priya's student page → **Documents** panel (or her milestone that requires the chapter revision).

DO Show the panel with any existing files.

SEE Rows with filename, uploaded by, timestamp, status pill.

SAY *“Every entity has a documents panel. Uploads live with the record they're about — not on a shared drive.”*

02 Upload a file

WHERE Panel → **+ Upload** button.

DO Pick a real PDF from disk (any small one). Add a description: "Chapter 2 revision, addressing panel conditions".

SEE New row appears with status "Scanning". Progress ring.

SAY *“Uploads are queued for virus scanning by a background worker — no synchronous surprise.”*

03 Watch the scan complete

WHERE Same row.

DO Wait a second or two. Refresh if needed.

SEE Status pill flips from amber "Scanning" to green "Available". Download link becomes clickable.

SAY *“Only clean files become downloadable. Anything flagged is quarantined and the uploader is notified.”*

04 Download the file

WHERE Row → **Download** icon (or the filename).

DO Click. File downloads.

SEE Browser saves it. Row's download-count increments.

SAY *“One click. But watch what happens on the audit side.”*

THE LINE

“Uploads scan. Files link to the entity that owns them. Downloads log — no file drifts without a trail.”

Identity & RBAC — create a user, assign a role, watch the UI change for them

WHAT IT IS

Users have roles; roles have permissions; permissions gate endpoints on the backend AND controls in the UI. When a user logs in, their JWT carries the tenant and the permission set, and the frontend uses that same set to grey out buttons the user can't act on. In this chapter we create a new user (a wellbeing officer), give them a role, log in as them, and confirm they see the sidebar, buttons and pages that role gets — and nothing else.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Users

WHERE Sidebar → **Settings** → **Users** tab (or /settings/users).

DO Land on the users table.

SEE Rows with role chips and active/inactive pills.

SAY *“Users have roles. Roles have permissions. The JWT carries the whole set — one auth check on the way in.”*

02 Create a new user

WHERE Top-right → **+ New user**.

DO Fill: email wellbeing@example.com, name Sam Cooper, temporary password, is_active on. Save.

SEE New row appears with no role chip yet.

SAY *“Just an account. No permissions yet — they can't even open the app.”*

03 Assign a role

WHERE On the new user's row → **Roles** column → **+ Assign role**.

DO Pick Wellbeing Officer. Save.

SEE Role chip appears. Permissions summary panel updates: student.read, notes.write, case.escalate.

SAY *“Assigning a role assigns its permissions. No per-user permission management to drift out of sync.”*

04 Open a role to show its permissions

WHERE Settings → **Roles** tab → open Wellbeing Officer.

DO Show its permission list.

SEE Permission codes like student.read, notes.write, case.escalate — no funding.change, no audit.read.

SAY *“Permissions name actions, not screens. A new screen inherits the right permissions automatically.”*

THE LINE

“The permission code gates the endpoint AND the button — one system of truth for what a user can do.”

Ask PGR — ask two questions, get an answer in 40 ms then a reasoned one

WHAT IT IS

A natural-language question box. Behind it: the **cohort resolver** figures out who the question is about ("first-years in Physics" → a concrete list), then either the **fast path** (deterministic SQL for common shapes — counts, filters, single values) or **typed tools** (for questions that need judgement) run. Answers arrive with evidence beside them — always auditable, always cite-able. In this chapter we ask one fast-path question and one that needs judgement, so the buyer sees both modes.

THE CLICKS

01 Open the palette

WHERE Any page. Press <kbd>Ctrl</kbd>+<kbd>K</kbd> (or the top-right search icon).

DO Palette opens centre-screen.

SEE Empty text box with placeholder "Ask about PGR data..."

SAY *"One box, one keystroke. Anywhere in the app."*

02 Ask a fast-path question

WHERE In the palette.

DO Type: how many first-years are at risk? Press Enter.

SEE Answer returns in under 100 ms with the number and a link to the filtered list.

SAY *"Fast path — this question has a direct SQL answer. Assistant doesn't need the model. Back in 40 ms."*

03 Click through the evidence link

WHERE The "N students" link on the answer.

DO Click. Land on a filtered students table.

SEE Every student the number counted, right there.

SAY *"The answer isn't just a number — it comes with the list that produced it. Auditable."*

04 Ask a judgement question

WHERE Palette again.

DO Type: who might not submit on time? Press Enter.

SEE Brief trace ticks (reading records, calling tools). Then a list of students with a one-line reason each, evidence links beside.

SAY *"This one needs judgement, so it calls the typed tools and the model composes. Evidence sits beside the sentence — every claim traceable."*

THE LINE

"Fast when the answer is arithmetic. Thoughtful when it isn't. Evidence always beside it."

Composer — ask a question, get a live dashboard, prove the citations

WHAT IT IS

Freeform question → planner picks data functions → they run against live data → the model composes a JSON render spec → the frontend validates it against 17 block types and renders. Every value in the prose has to appear in the underlying data — grounding is a mechanical check. If the model refuses or invents, a deterministic KPI-plus-table fallback renders instead. In this chapter we ask a per-student question that pulls a full progress dashboard for Priya, then a shape-different question about caseloads.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Composer

WHERE Sidebar → **Composer** (under ADVANCED, wand icon).

DO Land on the empty ask page.

SEE Big question box, list of example queries below.

SAY *“Ask a question. Get a dashboard. The model doesn't write SQL — it picks from a fixed catalogue.”*

02 Ask a full-student dashboard

WHERE Question box.

DO Type: Give me a full progress dashboard for Priya Nair. Press Enter.

SEE Trace ticks: *planning* → *calling functions* → *composing*. Blocks render one at a time — narrative paragraph, KPIs, timeline, milestones panel, funding lineage tree.

SAY *“Everything on this page was validated on the way in. The model picked the blocks — but the values came from typed data functions.”*

03 Prove the grounding

WHERE Any figure in the narrative (e.g. “£1,552 monthly stipend”).

DO Point at it. Then point at the funding-lineage tree beside it — the same figure appears there verbatim.

SEE Same number twice — prose and evidence.

SAY *“Every number in the paragraph appears in the data — grounding is a mechanical check. If the model invents, the grounded version doesn't render.”*

04 Ask a shape-different question

WHERE Same page.

DO Type: Show me supervisor caseloads against their caps. Press Enter.

SEE Different block (bar chart) with real caseload numbers.

SAY *“Bar chart because the functions returned rows with a limit. Composer picks the shape from the data, not from the phrasing.”*

THE LINE

“The composer can't invent a number — every value has a citation in the data.”

AI — Weekly review queue · watch the trace, then turn Wi-Fi off

WHAT IT IS

A deterministic scorer runs every active student against three signals — overdue milestones, funding gaps, expected end-date proximity — producing a scored table. The AI layer picks the top five with one sentence of reasoning per pick, from ids in the shortlist only. **Turn the model off** and the page still works: same evidence table on the right, top-five picks in score order on the left, chip flips from purple to grey. This is the flagship example of "AI as a layer, not a component" — and the demo moment the audience will remember.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Weekly review

WHERE Sidebar (under WORKSPACE) → **Weekly review** (sparkle icon, just below "Tasks").

DO Click. Do not touch the mouse for the next 3 seconds.

SEE Gradient pane appears. Four icons light up in turn: ■■ database → ■ calculator → ■ sparkles (pulses) → ■ layout.

SAY *“Every step is real server work — not a fake spinner. Fetch, weigh, wake the model, lay it out.”*

02 Point at the AI chip

WHERE Header of the left card — small pill next to "Top 5 to review this week".

DO Point at it. Purple = model-authored. Grey = fallback.

SEE Currently purple: ■ **Drafted just now**.

SAY *“Every AI-touched element in this app carries this pill. The reader knows in one glance what came from the model.”*

03 Cross-reference to the evidence

WHERE Right column — the "Evidence" table.

DO Point at a row highlighted faint red-brown — one of the AI's picks. Then point at the matching name on the left.

SEE Every pick on the left has its exact score and reasons on the right, verbatim.

SAY *“Picks left, deterministic evidence right. The AI can't invent a name that isn't on that table.”*

04 The model-off drill — the moment of truth

WHERE System tray → Wi-Fi icon.

DO Turn Wi-Fi off. Back in the app, click **Run again** (top-right).

SEE Trace still ticks. Chip flips to grey ■ **Generated offline**. Picks come back in pure score order with rule-based reasoning ("Flagged by: 2 milestone(s) overdue").

SAY *“Model off. The page still works. Chip is honest about it. That's the whole architectural commitment — AI is a layer, not a component.”*

THE LINE

“Turn the model off. The page still works. That's the test.”

AI — Meeting brief · click the button, read the brief, read the evidence

WHAT IT IS

Before every supervisor-student meeting, the platform assembles a typed evidence structure — last meeting date, agreed actions, changes since, open flags — and hands it to the AI narrator, which writes a two-sentence brief in colleague voice. Grounding forbids any date or figure not in the evidence; anything the model can't ground falls back to a plain template. Beside the paragraph, three rule-based questions to open the meeting with. **Not shipped by any other PGR system.** In this chapter we open Priya's brief (built from every action we've done in earlier chapters), read it aloud, and cross-check the evidence.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Priya's record

WHERE Sidebar → **Students** → **Priya Nair**.

DO Look top-right, next to the "Back to students" link.

SEE Grey secondary button: ■ **Prepare for meeting**.

SAY *“Every supervisor walks in cold — “so, where were we?” This is the answer, written before they open the door.”*

02 Click the button

WHERE The button.

DO Click. Right-side drawer slides in.

SEE Reasoning trace with four icons — ■■ record → ■ compare → =■ write → ■ lay out.

SAY *“Opening the record, comparing then and now, writing the brief, laying it out. Every step is real work.”*

03 Read the brief

WHERE Top of the drawer — tinted card labelled "The brief".

DO Read the paragraph aloud. Then point at the "What you agreed last time" callout below.

SEE Paragraph names Priya by first name, addresses "you" the supervisor. Every date and figure appears in the evidence.

SAY *“The paragraph is the reading. The evidence beside it is the citation. Grounding is a mechanical check — if a number isn't in the evidence, the model can't put it in the prose.”*

04 Cross-check one figure

WHERE Pick a specific number in the paragraph (e.g. "12 weeks ago").

DO Point at it. Then find the same figure in the "Changes since" or "Last meeting" evidence beside.

SEE Same figure — prose left, evidence right.

SAY *“If I claim a date and it's not in the evidence, the grounded check fails and the paragraph doesn't render. That's the guarantee.”*

“No other PGR system has this. It's the feature the demo remembers.”

Pattern Lab (ML) — run a prediction batch, review, approve, watch it reach the student page

WHAT IT IS

The quiet corner where machine-learning predictions live. A model produces predictions (say, submission-timeliness scores); an analyst reviews them; an approver signs them off; only then do the predictions become visible to end users. Permissions gate every step. Nothing an ML pipeline emits reaches a supervisor's screen without a human on the approval chain. In this chapter we open a recent batch, review it, approve one prediction, and then jump to that student's page to see the approved prediction appear.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Pattern Lab

WHERE Sidebar → **Pattern Lab** (under **ADVANCED**).

DO Show the runs list.

SEE Rows: model name, run date, prediction count, review status.

SAY *“Every ML run is a row here. Nothing gets promoted to production without going through review and sign-off.”*

02 Open a recent batch

WHERE Latest “submission timeliness” batch → click.

DO Show the predictions table.

SEE Columns: student, prediction (e.g. Likely to miss submission window), confidence (0.72), reviewer, approver, status.

SAY *“Every row is a prediction on one student. Confidence beside the label — nothing hidden.”*

03 Review one prediction

WHERE One row → **Review** button.

DO Read the input features shown, then click **Accept** or **Reject** with a note.

SEE Row's review status flips to “Reviewed” with my name and comment.

SAY *“Analyst pass. Confidence and features are visible — no black box.”*

04 Approve to promote

WHERE Same row → **Approve for release** (approver role, or same session with the right permission).

DO Click. Confirm.

SEE Row status flips green “Approved”. A visible-to-users flag appears on the record.

SAY *“Approver signs off. Nothing reached an end user before this click.”*

THE LINE

“Nothing an ML pipeline emits reaches an end user without a human on the approval chain.”

Settings & LOV — edit a reference value, tune a threshold, watch it take effect

WHAT IT IS

Reference data — funding types, milestone definitions, condition types, statuses, thresholds — lives here. Admins edit it directly through a CRUD UI; changes are versioned so historical records still point at the value they had when they were created. A separate **tunables registry** controls system behaviour (assistant tier, matching thresholds, workflow flags) without a code deploy. In this chapter we edit a reference value (add a new funding type), then change a tunable (bump the supervisor caseload cap) and confirm the workforce lens rerenders with the new threshold.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Settings

WHERE Sidebar → **Settings** (gear icon, ADMINISTRATION).

DO Show the tab bar at the top.

SEE Tabs: General, Users, Roles, Assistant, Reference data (LOV), Tunables, Notifications.

SAY *“Everything that used to live in a config file lives here — editable by an admin, versioned by the system.”*

02 Add a new funding type

WHERE **Reference data** tab → pick “Funding types” → **+ Add value**.

DO Fill: code `industry_direct`, label `Industry direct`, active on, valid_from today. Save.

SEE New row in the LOV table with valid_from = today.

SAY *“Any new funding type is one form. And the system records who added it and when — no config file drift.”*

03 Verify it's available upstream

WHERE Sidebar → **Research** → open any award → **Type** dropdown.

DO Point at the new option in the list.

SEE `Industry direct` now selectable.

SAY *“Live. The new value is available everywhere the reference is used.”*

04 Change a tunable

WHERE Settings → **Tunables** tab → find `supervisor.caseload.cap.default`.

DO Change from 8 to 10. Add reason: “Bumped for methodology reviewers pilot”. Save.

SEE Value updates; change history row lands under the tunable with actor + reason.

SAY *“System behaviour changes without a code deploy. Every change is audited with a reason.”*

THE LINE

“Reference data and system tunables live in the app, not in a config file — versioned, dated, audited.”